

Organizational Behaviour

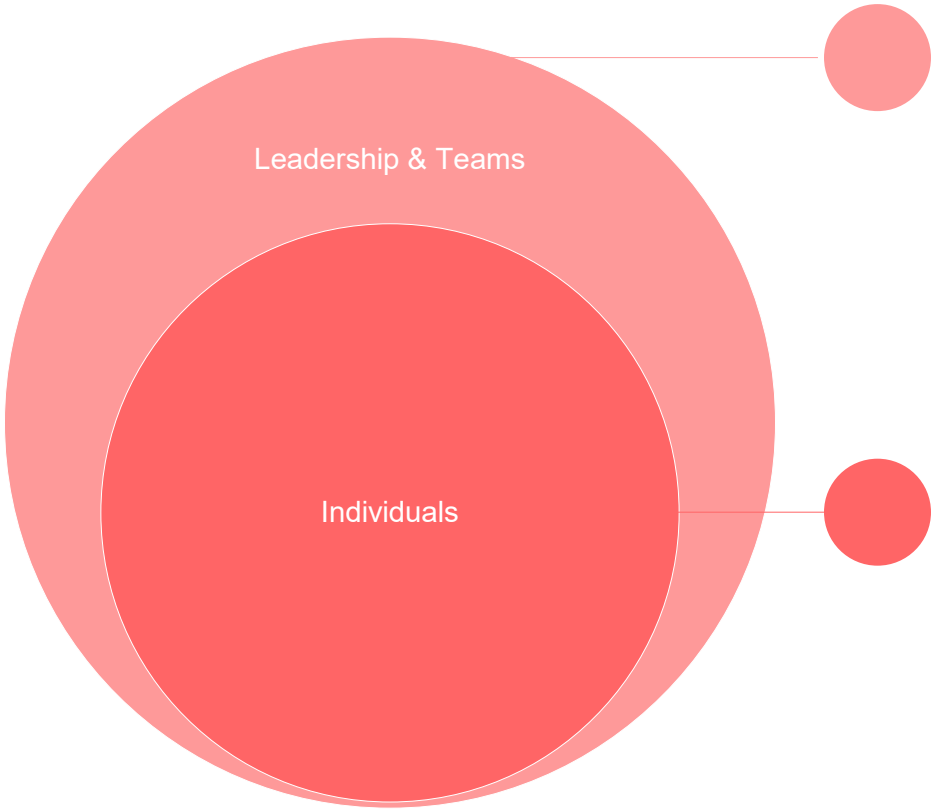
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MIM
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What is the study of organizational behavior?

The psychology of individuals, the dynamics of teams, and the structure of organizations (including their effect on how people in organizations act)



10. Leading Global Teams: Greg James
9. Leadership in an AI-enabled Context
8. Leading in an Uncertain World: YouTube
7. Conflict and Collaboration (Exercise)
6. Leading Teams: Bob Knowlton
5. Leadership Styles: FIFA 2010

4. Well-being & Happiness (Lecture)
3. Stress Management: Lucía Gómez
2. Motivation: Luis Arrese
1. Introduction: Hausser Foods

Let´s delve into the case!

Do we speak the same language?

Anglo-Dutch Translation Guide

What the British say	What the British mean	What the Dutch understand
With all due respect…	I think you were wrong.	He is listening to me.
Perhaps you would think about… I would suggest….	This is an order. Do it or be prepared to justify yourself.	Think about this idea and do it if you like.
Oh, by the way…	The following criticism of the purpose of the discussion is…	This is not very important.
I was a bit disappointed that…	I am very upset and angry that…	It doesn't really matter.
Very interesting…	I don't like it.	They are impressed.
Could you consider some other options?	Your idea is not a good one.	They have not yet decided.
Please think about that some more.	It's a bad idea. Don't do it	It's a good idea. Keep developing it.
I'm sure it's my fault.	It's not my fault.	It was their fault.
That is an original point of view	Your idea is stupid.	They like my ideas!

Communicating



US Netherlands Finland Spain Italy Singapore Iran China Japan
Australia Germany Denmark Poland Brazil Mexico France India Kenya Korea
Canada UK Argentina Russia Saudi Arabia Indonesia

Low Context ← → **High Context**

Low Context

- Good communication is **precise, simple, and clear**
- Messages are expressed and understood **at face value**
- **Repetition** is appreciated if it helps clarify the communication

High Context

- Good communication is **sophisticated, nuanced, and layered**
- Messages are both spoken and **read between the lines**
- Messages are often **implied** but not plainly expressed

Source: Meyer (2016)

Leading



Denmark Israel Canada US France Poland China Japan
Netherlands Finland UK Germany Italy Russia India Korea
Sweden Australia Brazil Mexico Peru Saudi Arabia Nigeria

Egalitarian ⟷ **Non-egalitarian**

Egalitarian

- The **ideal distance** between a boss and a subordinate is **low**
- The best boss is a **facilitator among equals**
- Organizational structures are **flat**
- Communication often **skips hierarchical lines**

Non-egalitarian

- The ideal distance between a boss and a subordinate is **high**
- The best boss is a **strong director** who leads from the front
- **Status** is important
- Organizational structures are **multi-layered and fixed**
- Communication follows set **hierarchical lines**

Source: Meyer (2016)

Trusting



US Denmark Germany UK Poland France Italy Mexico Brazil Saudi Arabia
Netherlands Finland Spain Russia Thailand India
Australia Japan Turkey China Nigeria

Task-based ← → **Relationship-based**

Task-based

- Trust is built through **business-related activities**
- Work relationships are built and dropped easily, based on the **practicality** of the situation
- You do good **work consistently**, you are **reliable**, I enjoy working with you, I trust you

Relationship-based

- Trust is built through **sharing meals, evening drinks, and visits at the coffee machine**
- Work relationships build up **slowly** over the longer term
- I've seen who you are **at a deep level**, I've shared personal time with you, I know others well who trust you, I trust you

Source: Meyer (2016)

Scheduling



Germany Japan Netherlands Poland Spain Italy Brazil China Saudi Arabia
Switzerland Sweden US UK Czechia France Russia Mexico India Nigeria
Denmark Turkey Kenya

Linear Time — **Flexible Time**

Linear Time

- Project steps are approached in a **sequential** fashion, completing one task before beginning the next
- One thing at a time. **No interruptions**
- The **focus is on the deadline** and sticking to the schedule
- Emphasis is on **promptness** and good organization over flexibility

Flexible Time

- Project steps are approached in a **fluid manner**, changing tasks as opportunities arise
- Many things are dealt with at once and **interruptions are accepted**
- The focus is on **adaptability and flexibility** is valued over organization

Source: Meyer (2016)

Faultlines: where does Greg's team split?

Faultline: an invisible line that splits a team into subgroups when several differences line up. The more they line up (real or perceived), the deeper the split.

	US · 11 people	**India** · 16 people	**UAE** · 11 people	**France** · 7 people
Weekly call (local time)	08:00	20:30–22:00, after a 06:30 start	19:00	17:00
Their grievance	Covering for French vacations	Maintenance and firefighting, not innovation	Relationship pace read as missed deadlines	Paid 30% less than the US
Access to Greg	Water-cooler talks; decisions made first	Agenda items last; interrupted	"Disconnected from you"	US the hardest to reach
How they feel	Seen as "favorites"	"Second-class citizens"	Afraid of ending up under India	"Our time is less valuable"

Source: Lau & Murnighan (1998); Thatcher & Patel (2012)

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FAULTLINE

Us vs. them

↑ conflict
↓ cohesion
↓ performance

1 Recognize

Name the subgroups out loud

2 Reduce

Build and stress one team identity

3 Redirect

A shared goal that every site owns

Source: Lau & Murnighan (1998); Thatcher & Patel (2012)

What did he do?

1 PROCESS
(task alignment)

- Unified the support queues
- One weekend protocol for every site

2 PRESENCE
(cohesion)

- Weekly staff meeting with his 8 managers
- Bi-weekly 1:1s + skip-level meetings with engineers
- Bi-annual deep-dive planning on the big picture
- Worldwide tech meetings on hot customer issues
- Open to spontaneous conversations

3 PROTECTION
(trust & identity)

- Took the heat from upper management alone
- Fired no one
- Took full responsibility for every mistake

Result: protecting the team built loyalty
Members began outdoing each other to perform for James

What changed, and what he learned

- Employee satisfaction up
- The team felt more united
- And also…

+72%	−21%	−48%
Customer satisfaction	Time to resolution	Case backlog

“I learned that as a manager, you will face crises. You are not a failure if they are created on your watch.

How you deal with these crises, however, will define your success as a leader."

Greg James



Let´s review what we have learned



Choose the right answer and be fast

Sign up with your first name and the initial of your surname


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Business School
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A Way to Learn
A Mark to Make
A World to Change